

Introduction, overview and trend language you can adapt to any chart, table, map or process diagram.

The 4-sentence introduction + overview

- **Paraphrase the rubric:** 'The provided line graph illustrates the proportion of ... between 2000 and 2020.'
- **Group the data:** 'Overall, the data can be broadly categorised into three groups: ...'
- **Main trend 1:** 'Overall, X experienced a dramatic rise, whereas Y declined steadily throughout the period.'
- **Main trend 2 / most striking feature:** 'It is also noticeable that ... recorded the highest figure in every year shown.'

The overview carries enormous weight: without a clear 'Overall' statement, Task Achievement cannot exceed Band 6. Write it after the introduction, before any detail paragraph, and mention only the two or three biggest patterns — never individual numbers.

Trend verbs — upgrade these

Weak (band 6)	Band 7+ alternatives
went up	climbed, surged, rocketed, soared, rose sharply / steadily / gradually
went down	fell, dropped, declined, plummeted, dipped, halved
stayed same	remained stable / constant, plateaued, levelled off at, held steady
big change	a dramatic / marked / substantial increase; a threefold rise
small change	a marginal / modest / slight fall; marginally below

Comparing & approximating

- 'X stood at exactly 40%, almost double the figure for Y.'
- 'By 2015, X had overtaken Y, reaching 60% compared with Y's 45%.'
- 'The figure for X was roughly / approximately / just under three times that of Y.'
- 'While X fluctuated between 20% and 30%, Y followed a consistently downward trajectory.'
- 'X accounted for the largest share, at just over a third of the total.'

Maps & process diagrams

- **Map change:** 'The playground was converted into a car park' / 'The village underwent significant redevelopment, most notably along the coastline.'
- **Map location:** 'situated to the north-west of', 'adjacent to', 'flanked by', 'relocated beside'.
- **Process sequence:** 'Initially / Subsequently / At the following stage / Once this has been completed / Ultimately'.
- **Process passive:** 'The beans are harvested, then roasted, before being ground and packaged.' — keep every step passive.

Numbers cheat-sheet

You see	You write
25%	a quarter of / exactly one in four
~50%	approximately half / just under a half
75%	roughly three-quarters
3×	three times as many / a threefold increase
12% → 24%	doubled, from 12% to 24%
48% → 24%	was halved / fell by half to 24%
1,000 → 4,000	quadrupled over the period shown

Timing drill: 20 minutes total — 3 to plan and find the overview, 14 to write, 3 to check verbs and prepositions. Never copy phrases from the question paper; paraphrase at least the verbs and nouns, or those words are subtracted from your word count.